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Search Committee
Department of Economics
Brown University
64 Waterman Street, Robinson Hall
Providence, RI 02912
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in Macroeconomics at Brown University, beginning July 1, 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Brown University's Department of Economics has a distinguished tradition of combining rigorous theory with empirical depth across macroeconomics, monetary economics, and international finance. The department's collaborative and research-active environment is an ideal setting for my work at the intersection of household finance and macroeconomic modeling. I am particularly drawn to Brown's intellectual diversity and interdisciplinary engagement through centers such as the Population Studies and Training Center and the Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students "convince themselves" that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured

office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Brown, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making.

I am deeply committed to promoting diversity, inclusion, and equitable access in economics. As both a researcher and a teacher, I value the intellectual and social benefits of diverse perspectives, and I seek to create an environment where all students feel their contributions are valued. My approach emphasizes clarity, accessibility, and mentorship, helping students from all backgrounds develop confidence in their analytical skills and in their role as contributors to economic thought.

I believe I would be a strong fit for Brown because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) collaborate across teams to translate insights into actionable formats for diverse audiences. I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to Brown's research and teaching missions, and to engage with its vibrant academic community.

I would be honored to join the Department of Economics at Brown University and to contribute to its research, teaching, and mentorship goals. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with the department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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